Sammy Abdella

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EDUCATION

Columbia University in The City of New York
B.S. Computer Science

SKILLS

Technical: Python, Git, Linux, REST, PostgreSQL, C++, Java, JavaScript, SQL, HTML/CSS, Ruby, OAuth2, JWT, Docker, Kubernetes
Languages: French, Arabic, English

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research | Columbia University Artificial Intelligence Laboratory Sep 2025 - May 2026

- Led the development for gAyl, an AI tool for LGBTQ+ suicide prevention, designed six model-based safety benchmarks to generate treatment plan recommendations and achieved <15% false-negative rate on unsafe-response detection across 1,000+ high-risk prompts
- Trained LLM-based classifiers in PyTorch and Hugging Face Transformers to automate safety evaluation, reducing manual benchmarking time by ~95%
- Publication: https://doi.org/10.7916/z6vc-d867

Intern | Meta Jun 2025 - Aug 2025

- Built a backend migration tool in Python and Hack to move a legacy presence service onto Meta's internal RPC framework. Cut tail latency on one of the read endpoints by ~22% and removed a deprecated dependency that had blocked two other teams.
- Added structured logging and a new set of MySQL based health metrics across three backend services, surfaced in internal dashboards. Reduced mean time to detect production regressions by ~30% during on call rotations.
- Wrote backfill scripts and shipped a schema change behind a feature flag that unblocked a multi region rollout. Code went through standard Meta diff review and was merged into production before the end of internship.

Intern | Amazon Jun 2024 - Aug 2024

- Built a Java + DynamoDB internal admin service that consolidated three legacy CLIs into a single REST API used by an on-call team of ~25 engineers. Cut average incident response time on a recurring class of tickets by ~40%.
- Wrote and shipped a CloudWatch alarm framework plus runbook updates for a backend pipeline, reducing repeat noisy alerts by ~25% over the rotation.
- Improved a batch reconciliation job by introducing pagination and parallel processing in Java. Reduced job runtime from ~6 hours to ~1.5 hours on production scale data.

Intern (part-time) | Columbia College Information Technology May 2023 - May 2026

- Migrated 43 Columbia departmental websites from Drupal 7 to Drupal 10, writing migration scripts, refactoring custom modules, handling regression testing, and improving average page load times by ~35% and eliminating 100% of deprecated modules in production
- Integrated a Django, PostgreSQL, and RESTful API backend with a new Columbia admissions website, scaling reliably to 50,000+ applicants per cycle, cutting form submission errors by ~40%, and reducing manual data correction work by ~50%